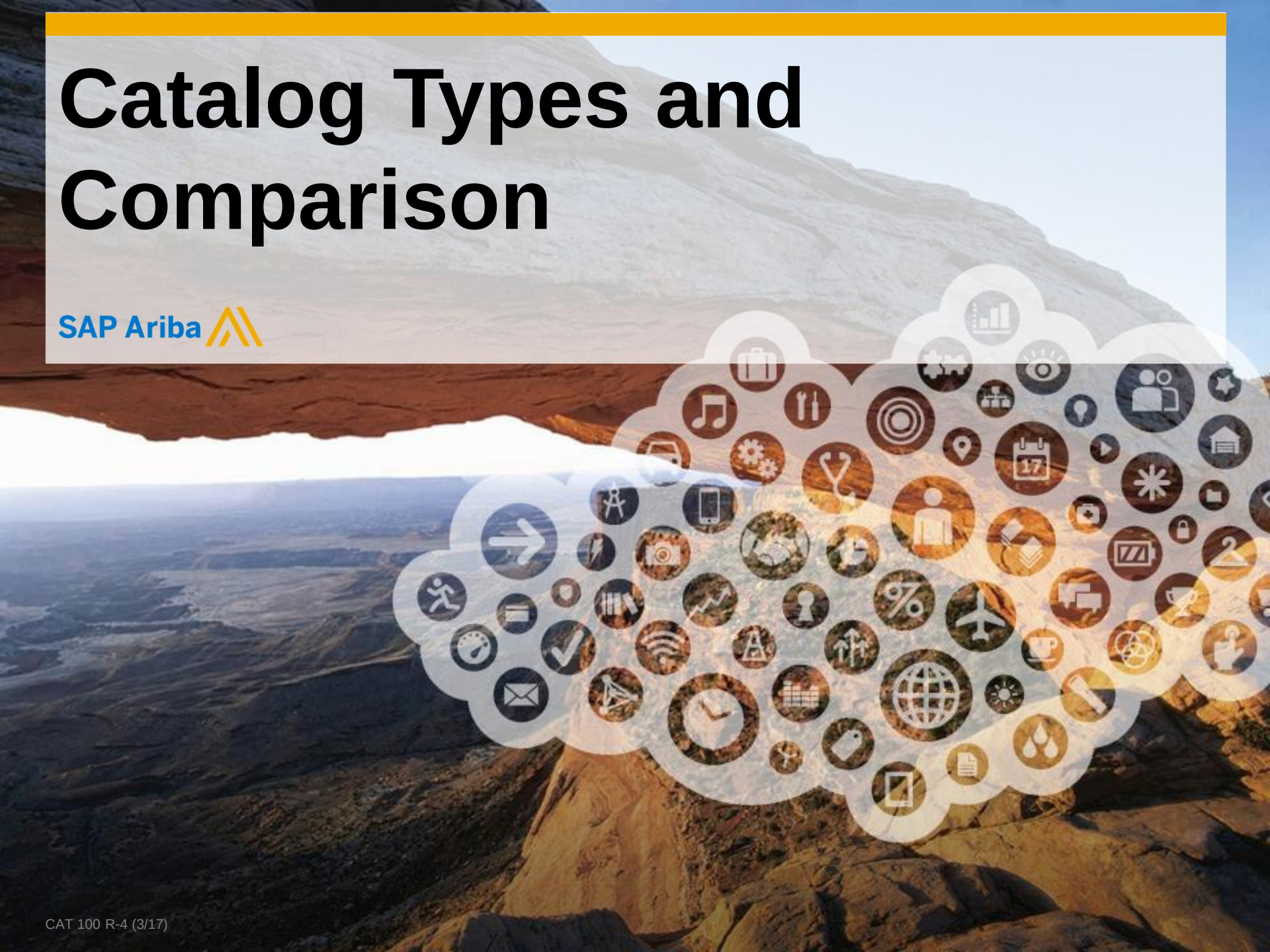
Catalog Types and Comparison

SAP Ariba



Catalog Types

Supplier catalogs in the Ariba solution are available in two types: static and PunchOut.

Static Catalogs	PunchOut Catalogs
§ Sometimes referred to as an internal catalog, a static catalog is a simple text file created and maintained by the Supplier § Ariba supports these catalog formats: CIF, cXML and BMECat § An Excel-based CIF template will be sent out to each Supplier Static catalogs work well if: § Supplier is new to Ariba Network and/or to catalog management § Supplier is unable to host their own ordering websites § Catalog is small to medium size § Catalog content is more static, with minimal updates § Need for tight control and auditing	§ Allows users to access catalog content residing at a Supplier's interactive e-commerce website § Supplier controls and maintains content on their site § Content is specific to the Customer PunchOut catalogs work well if: § Catalog contains configurable items § Catalog requires frequent updates § Catalog is very large § Additional value added features are available (real time availability, quote functions, etc.) § Supplier already has a PunchOut website

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Catalog Types - Static

Catalog Interchange Format (CIF), cXML or BMECat

- Static file, maintained and uploaded by Suppliers to Ariba Network, or created and managed by the Buying organization. File contains complete information for each SKU—Part Number, Price, Description, Image link, Commodity Code, etc.
- Static catalogs allow for these configurables:
  - Custom fields
  - Partial Items
  - Kits
  - Item Rankings and Promoted Items

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Catalog Types – Static (CIF)

A static CIF catalog can be built from a comma-separated Excel based template.

The Supplier is given instructions and an Excel template, then creates and uploads the file to Ariba Network.

Here is a sample of an Excel CIF file:

Header Section

	A	B	C
1	**CIF_I_V3.0**		
2	CHARSET:	UTF-8	
3	LOADMODE:	F	
4	CODEFORMAT:	UNSPSC	
5	CURRENCY:	USD	
6	SUPPLIERID_DOMAIN:	NetworkID	
7	ITEMCOUNT:	5	
8	TIMESTAMP:	03/14/2014	
9	UNUOM:	TRUE	
10	COMMENTS:	Customer Name and comments	

Data Section

11	FIELDNAMES: Supplier ID	Supplier Part ID	Manufacturer Part ID	Item Description	SPSC Code	Unit Price	Unit of Measure	Lead Time	M
12	DATA								
13	AN09067477712	2772882	TTSIBM412CID	4-Line System Phone with Headset and Caller ID	43191504	45.24	EA	1	Int
14	AN09067477712	2772967	IDG076450049X	Excel 97 for Dummies Quick Reference Book	55101509	19.99	EA	1	ID
15	AN09067477712	2772276	IDG076458722	Blue Ballpoint Pens, Disposable	44121704	5.45	DZN	1	Bi
16	AN09067477712	2772981	IDG076450052X	Manilla Folders, Tabbed 3 Position	44122011	19.99	GRO	1	Me
17	AN09067477712	2772985	IDG07645762	Stapler, Swingline 405, Black	44121615	4.95	EA	1	Sv
18	ENDOFDATA								

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Catalog Types - Static Item View

This is how a static catalog item is displayed in the catalog interface. Clicking on the Short Name takes you to the Details screen for this item.

Short Name

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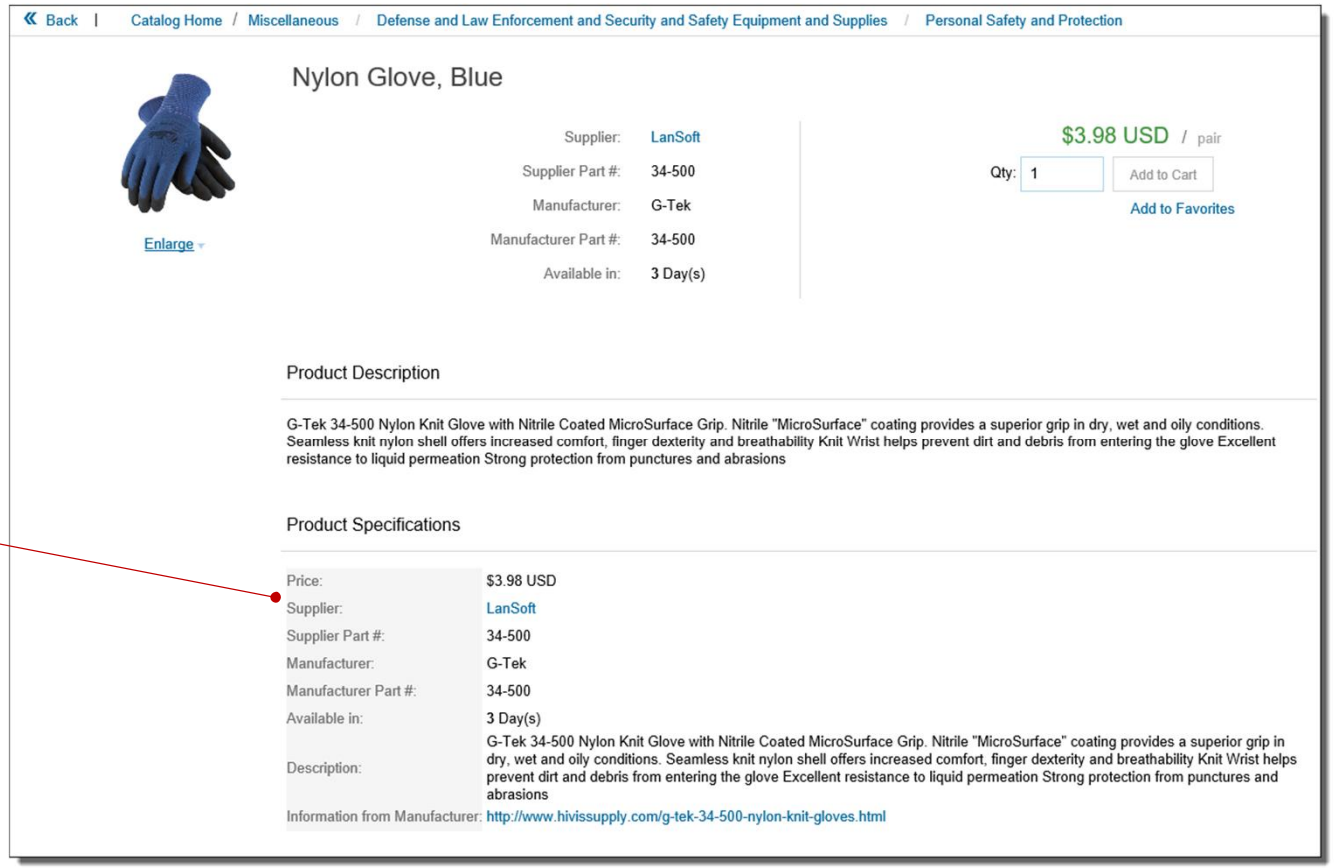
Catalog Types – Static Item Detail View

This is a how a static catalog Item Detail view is displayed in the catalog interface.

Additional Information, links and custom fields



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Catalog Types - Static

Static Advantages

- Very easy to get up and running (static file upload)
- Maximum control and audit for contract compliance
- Catalog approval workflow
- User searches in Ariba interface, gets results and can compare items side-by-side
- Users can create Favorites
- Item ranking

Static Disadvantages

- No real-time inventory or pricing
- Supplier management to keep catalogs current
- Large files must be split for Network loading

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Catalog Types - PunchOut

Because PunchOut catalogs use a Supplier's website, there is more complexity in configuration, and Suppliers must have the infrastructure and tools necessary for PunchOut transactions.

PunchOut uses the cXML protocol, based on XML and created by Ariba. cXML is freely available and is well documented for Suppliers.

www.cxml.org

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Catalog Types - PunchOut

PunchOut Level 1

- The catalog interface shows a link to a Supplier's external website. Users click a **Buy From Supplier** button, and punch out of the catalog interface to the Home Page of the Supplier's site
- User searches Supplier's site for items, adds to the Supplier's Shopping Cart, and returns to the Ariba application
- Supplier uploads typically a 1-line comma separated, index file to Ariba Network
- Catalogs are maintained by Suppliers on their website
- PunchOut can allows for
  - **Dynamic Quotes—**User can work with their sales person, obtain a quote and have it loaded as a SKU on the PunchOut website for easy and accurate ordering
  - **Real time information—**Like pricing and availability
  - **Item Configuration—**"Build your own" with custom pricing

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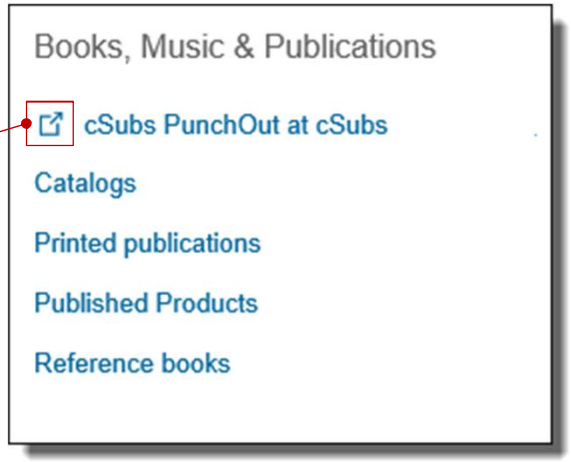
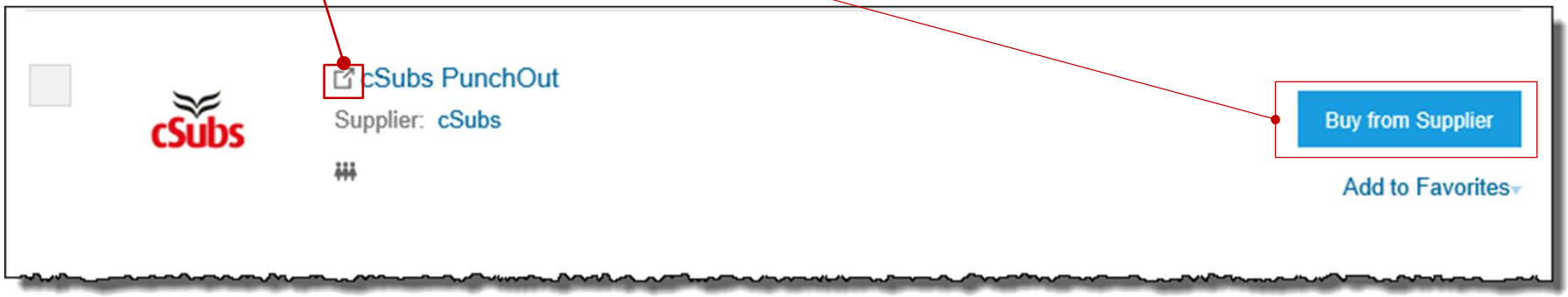
Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 1 View

This is how a PunchOut catalog item is displayed in the catalog interface by drilling down to the category, or getting a search result.

The PunchOut icon tells you that this is an external catalog, as well as the “Buy From Supplier” button.





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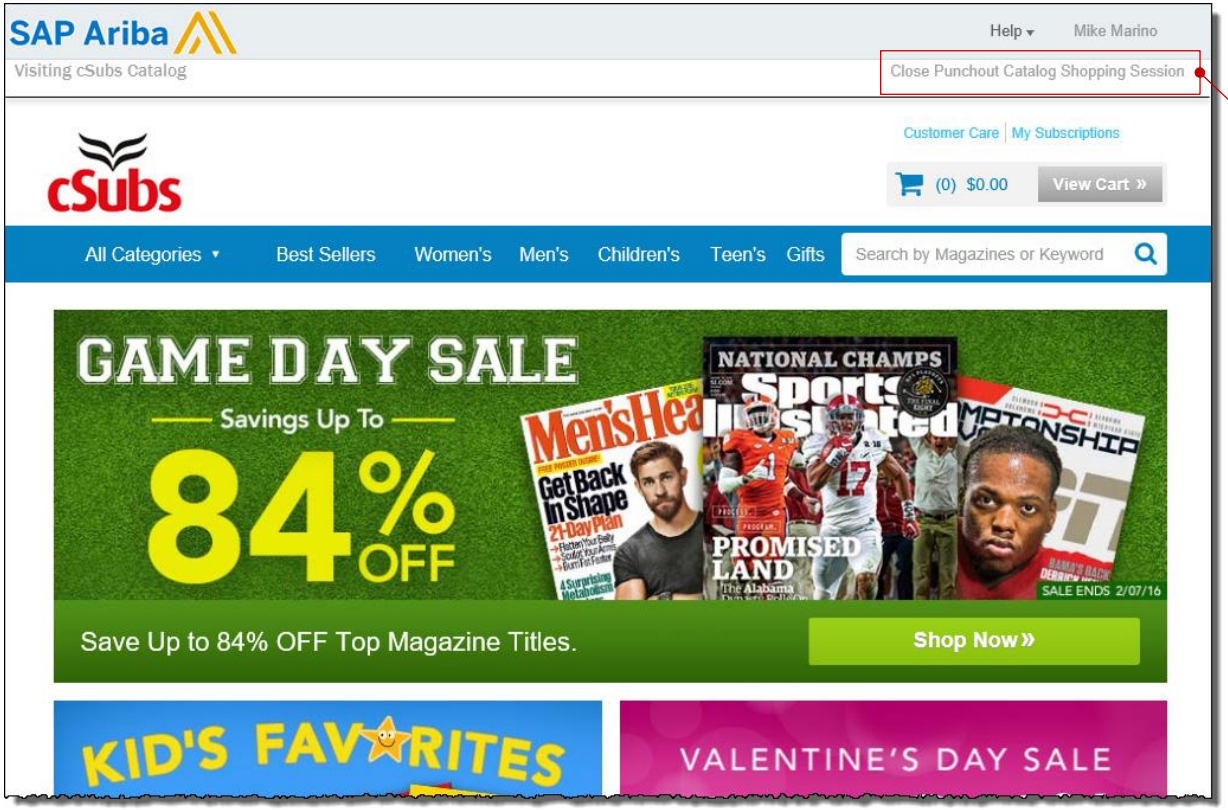
Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 1 View

When you click the **Buy From Supplier** button, you are taken to the Supplier's website, where you search and add items to the website's Shopping Cart, then return them to Ariba .



You are on the Supplier site, but still within the Ariba Catalog. You can click here to close the PunchOut session and return.

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Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 1

Level 1 Advantages

- Real time inventory and pricing (if provided by Supplier)
- Leverage Supplier's website and any features and rich content that may be there
- eQuotes and custom configurations

Level 1 Disadvantages

- User must know which Supplier to buy the commodities from—cannot do an Ariba search and get specific results
- User cannot create favorite items (on Ariba interface)
- Each site has a different look-and-feel Users have to learn
- Supplier controls the content and pricing. Audit for contract compliance is manual, outside the system
- Somewhat more complicated for Suppliers to set up

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Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 2

PunchOut Level 2

- The catalog interface shows search results like a static catalog, then Users click a **Buy From Supplier** button, and punch out of Ariba to the Supplier's site directly to the specific item or category they chose
- Supplier uploads a CIF-like, static index file, with a line for each SKU, to Ariba Network.
- Catalogs are maintained by Suppliers on their website, and they maintain the index file sent to Ariba (can be automated)
- Level 2 PunchOut allows for
  - **Searching in the Ariba application for items**—results are returned for both static and PunchOut Catalogs—you don't have to know who the Supplier is before you start the purchase
  - **Real time pricing and availability** (if provided by the Supplier)
  - **Punching in at Aisle level, Shelf level or Product level** (for example: Aisle—Optical Media, Shelf—DVD-R, Product—Maxell DVD-R Part 5435

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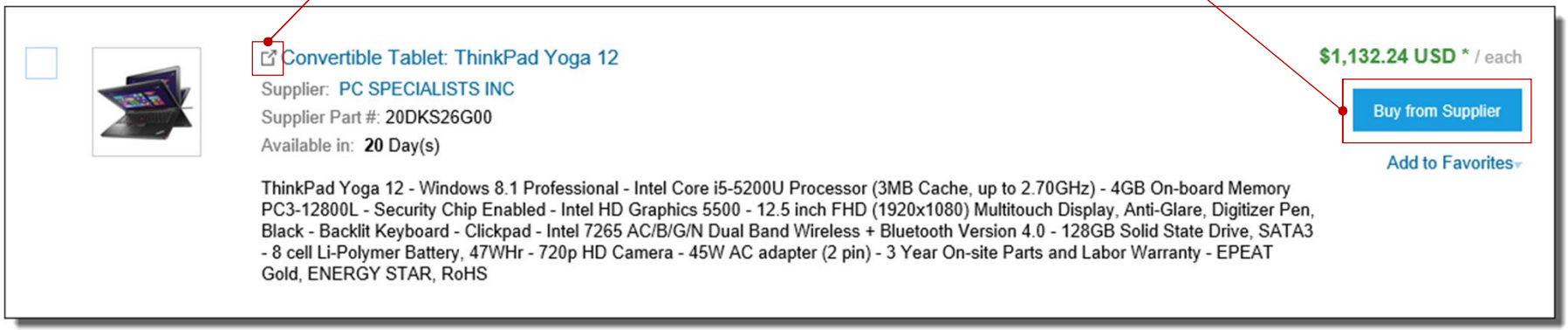
Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 2 View

Starting a normal search for a “ThinkPad Yoga” in the catalog, returns this result.

Notice the Search result looks just like a static catalog—but has the **Buy From Supplier** button, rather than **Add to Cart**. Click the **Buy From Supplier** button to initiate the PunchOut.

The PunchOut icon tells you that this is an external catalog, as well as the “Buy From Supplier” button.



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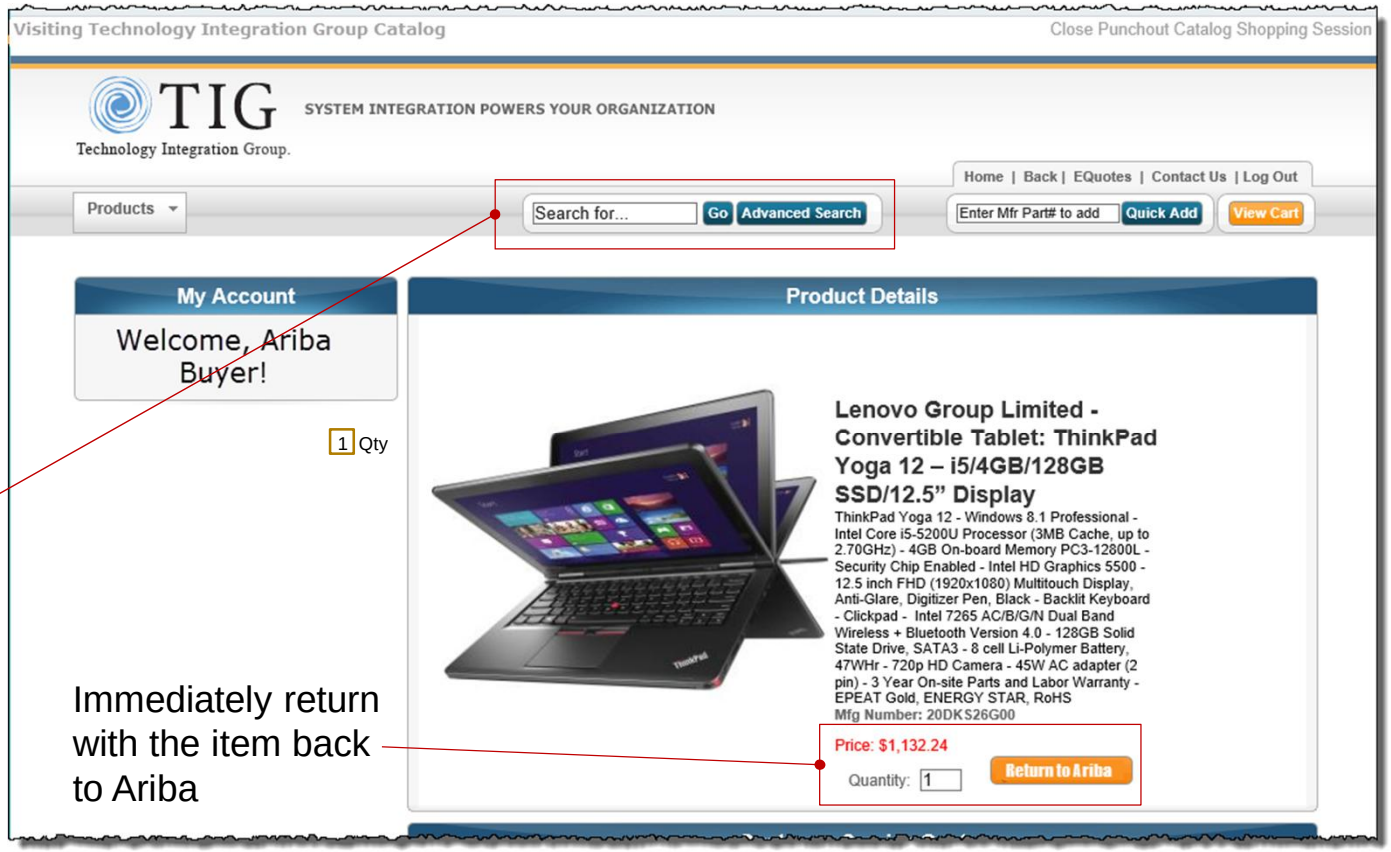
Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 2 View

The system punches in to the Supplier site, directly to the specific item. The site presents current pricing, information, availability—anything the Supplier has programmed into the website.

- You can immediately bring the item back to Ariba, or continue to shop the web catalog.



Allows you to continue shopping on the site.

Immediately return with the item back to Ariba

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Catalog Types - PunchOut Level 2

Level 2 Advantages

- User searches in Ariba interface, gets results and can compare items side-by-side—static or PunchOut
- User can create favorites (in Ariba interface)
- Real time inventory and pricing (if provided by the Supplier)
- Leverage Supplier's website and any features and rich content that may be there
- Aisle, Shelf or Product level

Level 2 Disadvantages

- More complicated to set up—must make modifications to a Level 1 site
- Supplier has to maintain PunchOut Index file for each SKU, upload to Customer to keep current (can be automated)
- If pricing is required in the Index file, when the User punches out to the site, the current price of the item may be different

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Thank You